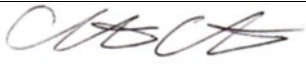


Guideline Title: Warming of Blood Products & Intravenous Fluids

Guideline Number: GUID-3203-PR026

Warming of Blood Products & Intravenous Fluids

Issue date: 09/01/2020	Replaces Dept. Policy:
Revision dates: 6/8/2021	Developed by: Air Care Team
Approved by: Christopher Hunter, MD Air Care Team Medical Director	Approved by:
Signature: 	Signature:
Department Numbers: 3203	

CCCXXXVII. **PURPOSE:** To provide guidance on warming blood products and intravenous fluids using the approved Belmont Buddy Lite warming device.

CCCXXXVIII. **DEFINITIONS:** None

CCCXXXIX. **DEPARTMENT GUIDELINE:**

A. Set-up

- i. The disposable set must be inserted into the device before priming.
- ii. Fit the disposable set so red marker on the device aligns with red marking of the set.
- iii. Close the heater so a click is heard.

B. Priming

- i. Prime blood giving set with 100ml of saline.
- ii. Add 3-way tap if required to end blood giving set (for intraosseous).
- iii. Connect giving set to blue end of the Buddy disposable set.
- iv. Prime the set by running fluid through.
- v. Tap the heater (to discourage bubbles).
- vi. There is no need to remove the distal red cap for priming.

C. Operation

- i. Turn the heater on – a blue light confirms operation.
- ii. Connect the red end directly to the patient's cannula.
- iii. Do not have any other bungs/stoppers, 3-way taps, extension sets etc. between the heater and the cannula (to minimize heat loss).
- iv. Secure the heater to the sheet with the green clip.
- v. Start infusing. A pressure bag may increase flow rate.

- vi. If pushing through via 3-way tap and syringe, be smooth and gentle.

D. Battery Charge

- i. Indicator is on the base of the unit.
- ii. Battery will power warmer for 3 liters of cool fluid.

E. Be aware

- i. Temperature achieved depends on flow rate and initial fluid temp.
- ii. A pressure release valve operates at 300 mmHg.
- iii. Alarms are indicated by red LED on battery housing and will usually relate to “out of temperature” range caused by low or high flow rates. Alarm is cleared by turning OFF and ON again.

CCCXL. **DOCUMENTATION:** EMS Charts
CCCXLI. **REFERENCES:** None